E PLAY BUTTON

define my attitude to photography. I would rather photograph my subjects in their natural surroundings so they can be who they are, free from intervention," says Roy, whose Bachpan series started to take shape informally from 2009. In this series, Roy examines the cultural patterns of childhood play by observing underprivileged children who, with limited access to toys, lean on community, creativity and found materials.

ROY'S **'BACHPAN'** SERIES STARTED TO TAKE SHAPE INFORMALLY IN 2009. THE SHOW IS ON AT DELHI'S VADEHRA ART GALLERY TILL MAY 30

The Janwaar series, named after a nondescript village in Madhya Pradesh, was triggered after a German friend of Roy's wanted to construct a skate park there in 2015. The project was periodically documented, capturing not only the building process but also the transformation it sparked among the children and wider community. "What caught my attention was how local kids embraced skating. There were no trainers; they fell and got back up, learning in the process. Two basic guidelines were soon adopted. First: no school, no skateboarding; and second, girls first. This produced strong, inclusive surroundings full of vitality and passion," says the photographer.

Roy writes his memories and observations on society and life through images. It's the only way he knows how to convey the "human experience" that shapes him and the realities around him. ■

–Arshia

it takes the form of a painting. It need not only be a physical pain, it could be the pain of creation itself," explains Thakur.

His watercolour, 'Cat and the Fish', reveals a profound connection to Bengal. Works such as 'The Musical Meet' portray couples in an intimate yet timeless way. 'The Open Parlour' highlights intergenerational care, something that Thakur feels is disappearing in urban society.

Since 1974, his primary medium for acrylic and watercolour works has been Nepalese rice paper. Thakur's studies of Egyptian wall paintings inspired him to integrate their geometric sophistication into his stylised human figures. "The modernistic approach conjoined with the interpretation of his environment creates a powerful, original language," adds Saurabh Singhvi, director at Art Magnum. ■

—Neha Kirpal



'DOMINUS AERIS' by Thukral and Tagra

EXHIBITION ▼

INDIA ON CANVAS

Contemporary Indian art is in the spotlight at a major group exhibition at the City Palace, Jaipur

The Jaipur Centre for Art (JCA), in collaboration with *Whitewall* magazine, has an ongoing exhibition, *India in Dialogue: Tradition & Transformation*, at the City Palace in the city. "The exhibition was conceived as a dialogue between the enduring legacy of Jaipur's cultural heritage and the dynamic expressions of contemporary Indian art," explain Laurent Moïsi & Michael Klug, co-founders of *Whitewall* magazine. It brings together a dynamic group of artists, spanning generations and practices, encompassing sculpture, painting, drawing, photography, installation and digital media. Featuring both established and emerging voices, such as Asim Waqif, Biraaj Dodiya, Jitish Kallat, Mark Prime, Narayan Sinha, Prarthna Singh, Rana Begum, Shilpa Gupta, Tarini Sethi and Thukral & Tagra, the artists reflect a cultural moment shaped by questions of memory, materiality, identity and transformation. "We're exploring a new model of exhibition-making, one that places Indian artistic practices in direct dialogue with broader international conversations, while honouring the rich cultural lineage from which they emerge," says Noelle Kadar, co-founder, JCA. ■

INDIA IN DIALOGUE... IS OPEN TO THE PUBLIC AT THE JAIPUR CENTRE FOR ART TILL JUNE 8

—Neha Kirpal